

This kind of popularity and involvement of the audience, the league's core customer, has made IPL a veritable money-spinning machine. Media rights for the tournament have been climbing. In 2008, Sony had paid ₹8,200 crore for television rights for the period 2008-17. After that, the then Star India picked up the television and digital rights to the marquee tournament for ₹16,348 crore (\$2.55 billion) for the period 2018-22. Smelling more money, the television and digital rights were then split and given to two different entities—Disney Star for television and Viacom18 for digital streaming—for a combined value of ₹48,390 crore (\$6.2 billion) for the period 2023-27.

That makes IPL the fifth-most valuable sporting league in the world, an appellation that would bring a wry smile to your face, considering the top-drawer of the sport comprises just about seven to eight countries. "Purely from a financial implication, the arrival of the IPL is the biggest tipping point since it moved the balance away from two to three established powers towards India," says Bhogle.

IPL is now behind only four major leagues—the National Football League in the US (NFL, media rights worth \$112.6 billion for 2023-33); the NBA (National Basketball Association, \$24 billion for 2014-2025); English Premier League soccer (\$12.85 billion for 2022-25); and Major League Baseball in the US (\$12.24 billion for 2022-28).

But Indian cricket is not only IPL. Media rights for International Cricket Council (ICC) tournaments have also been sold for close to \$3 billion to Disney Star. The impending sale of rights for all bilateral matches to be played in India and organised by the Board of Control for Cricket in India (BCCI) is expected to fetch at least \$1 billion. And if you add what IPL's two new team owners spent last year, that's almost ₹13,000 crore. Adding to these what other IPL team owners have paid in the past, cricket in India is a ₹1 lakh-crore industry. That's big, and it's only growing bigger.



THE T20 STORY

- ▶ India's victory in the inaugural T20 World Cup in 2007 set the ball rolling for the IPL
- ▶ The media rights for the IPL were sold for ₹8,200 crore for 10 years when the tournament started in 2008; last year, these rights were clinched for ₹48,390 crore, for a five-year period
- ▶ The IPL and the World Cup together account for 80 per cent of total cricket viewership out of India
- ▶ Digital is the emerging big story after JioCinema aired this year's IPL free of cost
- ▶ Going forward, there is a good chance that T20 will only gain in stature as the established format

CRICKET, A ₹1 LAKH CRORE BUSINESS

IPL media rights for 2023-27	₹48,390 crore
Media rights for ICC tournaments (2024-27)	\$3 billion (₹24,794 crore)
Media rights for Women's Premier League (2023-27)	₹951 crore
BCCI's estimated earnings from its bilateral tournaments	\$1 billion (₹8,265 crore)
Estimated production costs	₹3,000 crore
Total earnings from auction of IPL franchises	₹15,391 crore
Total	₹1,00,791 crore

BASED ON EXCHANGE RATE AS OF JUNE 5, 2023;
SOURCE: OFFICIAL ANNOUNCEMENTS, MEDIA REPORTS

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